VIPEINK

Next-Generation Tokenized Banking Payment System on TON

Business Plan — Pre-Seed Round

Economic Model v3.1 Stage-Based · March 2026

“Settlement finality in 5.2 seconds instead of 4 banking days.
Designed for operational independence after Pre-Seed.
Unit economics turn positive at 10M tx/year — one bank partner.”

Investment ask:	**$1,192,000 Pre-Seed**
Jurisdiction:	Lithuania (EMI) · EU (MiCA/CASP)
Blockchain:	The Open Network (TON)
Break-even:	10M tx/year · 1 bank partner · 6–12 months
Net margin (Pilot):	**59.8% at 1.65% fee rate**
Self-funding:	Designed from first paid pilot (Q1–Q2 2027)
Instrument:	SAFE · 20% discount · cap $9.4M

Confidential. This document is intended solely for prospective Pre-Seed investors. Unauthorized distribution is prohibited.

INVESTMENT HIGHLIGHTS

- **What:** Regulated payment middleware on the TON blockchain that settles interbank transactions in 5.2 seconds via ZK-Rollup, replacing 1–4 day SWIFT correspondent flows for Tier-2/3 banks across the EEA.
- **Why Now:** MiCA regulation (2025), ISO 20022 migration (2025–2027) and production-grade ZK cryptography have converged to create a narrow window for compliant blockchain-based settlement infrastructure.
- **Ask:** $1,192,000 SAFE with 20% discount, $9.4M valuation cap.
- **Use of Funds:** Licenses 56% · Audits 16% · Development 12% · Reserve 16%.
- **Key Metric:** Break-even at 10M tx/year — equivalent to one Tier-3 bank partner, achievable within 6–12 months of first pilot.
- **Path to $30M ARR:** 2–5 bank partners generating 20–50M tx/year at 1.65% fee. Net margin 59.8% at Pilot scale.
- **Exit:** 6–30× over 3–5 years via M&A (Worldline, Adyen, BNP Paribas, ING) or optional Series A for acceleration.
- **Team:** *[TO BE ADDED: key founder names]* — mathematician/architect, systems engineer, economist/GTM, marketing lead. Four co-founders covering all mission-critical domains from Day 1.

Contents

Investment Highlights 3

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY 5

2 PROBLEM AND OPPORTUNITY 6

3 SOLUTION: INVISIBLE MIDDLEWARE 7

4 MARKET 10

5 MARKET VALIDATION 15

6 BUSINESS MODEL AND MONETIZATION 19

7 OPERATING MODEL AND GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY 22

8 TECHNOLOGY 25

9 COST STRUCTURE 28

10 SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS AND RISKS 33

11 TEAM 35

12 INVESTMENT PROPOSAL 39

13 EXIT STRATEGY 42

14 ROADMAP AND MILESTONES 43

Appendix A: Data Room Contents 45

Appendix B: Theoretical Scale Ceilings 45

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Investment Thesis in One Paragraph

Vipeink is building a regulated payment rail on the TON blockchain that reduces interbank settlement time from 4 days to 5.2 seconds and delivers a 59.8% net margin at the transaction volume of a single bank partner. The $1.19M Pre-Seed covers EMI+MiCA licensing and all mandatory audits. Every subsequent growth stage is designed to be funded from transaction revenue; Series A is optional, solely for acceleration. For the investor, this means: **capped capital risk, fixed maximum expenditure, and a 6–30× exit potential over a 3–5 year horizon**.

International interbank settlements are one of the few financial markets where infrastructure has not changed fundamentally since the 1970s. SWIFT MT103 takes 1–4 business days [14], every node in the chain duplicates KYC/AML checks, and Tier-2/3 banks either overpay correspondent banks or lose fintech clients. Vipeink addresses all four structural defects at the protocol level — through ZK-Rollup, an atomic ZK+SWIFT Bridge and an embedded compliance layer.

The key fact that distinguishes Vipeink from most fintech startups: **the business reaches profitability at the volume of a single bank partner**. Break-even is 10 million transactions per year, or 0.3 TPS. That is equivalent to a small regional bank over 6–12 months of operation.

Key financial parameters — path from Pilot to Regional scale:

Table 1: Financial Model: Pilot to Regional Scale (Economic Model v3.1)

Parameter	Break-even	Pilot	Regional
Volume (tx/year)	10M	50M	1B
Fixed costs/year	$8.54M	$8.54M	$26.1M
Revenue (1.65%)	$9.1M	$45.4M	$907.5M
Net Profit	$0	$27.2M	$651.7M
Net Margin	0%	**59.8%**	**71.8%**

Source: Economic Model v3.1 Stage-Based Scaling, February 2026. National and Global stages are presented in Appendix B as theoretical ceilings.

As volume grows, **net margin increases** (59.8% → 71.8%), whereas in traditional payment systems it typically declines due to operational complexity.

This is an architectural consequence: Vipeink's variable costs are $0.01253/tx and do not scale proportionally with volume.

> **Why Pre-Seed is an asset acquisition, not a cash burn.** 71.68% of Pre-Seed expenditure ($854K) consists of fixed government fees and auditor tariffs — they are independent of operational outcomes. The EMI license capital ($413K) is a *regulatory asset*: it is held on the company balance sheet as required capital [11]. The investor is not funding a startup searching for product-market fit — they are funding the licensing of an already-designed architecture.

2. PROBLEM AND OPPORTUNITY

The cross-border B2B payments market — $190 trillion per year [1, 2] — operates on infrastructure that has not changed fundamentally since SWIFT launched in 1973 [43]. Banks and corporations tolerate delays, duplicate compliance checks and high fees not because they are unaware of alternatives, but because no alternative has yet obtained the necessary regulatory foundation and passed banking-grade audits. Vipeink closes exactly that gap.

Four Structural Defects We Address

1. **Speed.** SWIFT MT103 takes 1–4 business days [14] — from 86,400 to 345,600 seconds. Vipeink settles in **5.2 seconds**. For a corporate treasurer, this means the shift from "funds stuck for a week" to "funds arrived before the call ended."

2. **Cost.** The all-in client fee at Visa is 1.65–2.90% [19]; PayPal charges 2.90% with variable costs of $0.075/tx [21]. Vipeink's variable cost is $0.01253/tx. At scale, this enables a fee **below Visa** while preserving a 73%+ margin.

3. **Compliance duplication.** Every node in the correspondent chain runs its own KYC/AML check. The industry spends $40+ billion per year on this [17, 46] — and still misses violations because each participant sees only its own fragment of the transaction. Vipeink embeds compliance into a ZK-proof: *once, at the protocol level*, with mathematically provable correctness [42].

4. **Tier-2/3 exclusion.** Banks with assets below $1 billion lack direct SWIFT membership [44, 45] and pay correspondents a double markup — or lose

fintech clients. This segment (67% of whose treasurers call correspondent settlement costs "critically unacceptable", McKinsey 2024 [3]) is Vipeink's primary target audience.

Why the Opportunity Window Opened Now

The largest infrastructure opportunities arise at the intersection of mature technology, regulatory change, and unmet demand. All three factors have converged in 2025–2026.

Table 2: Factors Creating the Market Window for Vipeink

Factor	Description	Timing
ISO 20022 migration	SWIFT infrastructure upgrade creates an insertion point; Vipeink is natively compatible [13]	From 2025
ZK maturity	Plonky2, Groth16 and TON reached production-grade [35, 36, 37] — commercial product is now buildable	2024–2025
MiCA + AMLD6	New EU regulatory framework [8, 10] makes embedded ZK-compliance a *competitive advantage*, not an option	2025
Demand surge	67% of Tier-2/3 bank treasurers call SWIFT correspondent costs "critically unacceptable" [3]	Now

Investor Insight

Companies entering payment infrastructure during regulatory transitions — as Stripe did in 2010 at the dawn of online payments [34], or Wise in 2011 at the shift to open banking [47] — gain a 5–10 year time buffer ahead of incumbent competitors. MiCA 2025 [8] is the same type of inflection point for B2B crypto-based settlements.

3. SOLUTION: INVISIBLE MIDDLEWARE

The conceptual foundation of Vipeink is the **invisible middleware** principle: the bank retains its client, its license and its familiar interface; Vipeink executes the settlement rail "under the hood" through a four-layer ZK architecture. From the bank's perspective, this looks like an ordinary API call.

Internally, it is a cryptographically proven atomic settlement with 5.2-second finality.

This means **zero integration barrier for the bank**: no need to change the client interface, retrain staff, or obtain additional licenses. Vipeink connects via REST API to the existing banking system — the same way any cloud service does.

Four-Layer Architecture

Table 3: Vipeink Architecture: From Intent to Settlement

Layer	Function	Key Guarantee
Intent Layer	Encryption of payment intent {from, to, amount, currency}; AES-256	Data privacy
ZK-Rollup Layer	Batch processing via Plonky2 [35]/Groth16 [36]; Merkle root anchored to TON blockchain [37]	$P[\text{error}] < 2^{-80}$
Settlement Bridge Layer	Atomic Jetton $\leftrightarrow$ MT103 SWIFT bridge [14]; two-phase commit; 3 watchers (Phase 1) $\rightarrow$ 7 watchers (Phase 2)	Either both legs settle or full roll-back
Banking Layer	Final SWIFT settlement [39]; REST API integration with the bank	Complete audit trail

Formal Security Guarantees

Unlike most blockchain projects, where security is described qualitatively, Vipeink possesses **30+ mathematically proven theorems** (Technical Specification v4.0). Key reliability parameters:

- $P[\text{partial execution}] < 2^{-80}$ — atomicity of settlement guaranteed at the cryptographic level;
- $P[\text{tx fails}] < 10^{-12}$ — the probability of a transaction failure is negligibly small;
- $P[\text{DAS attack}] < 10^{-150}$ — resistance to data availability attacks [40];
- $k \geq 3$ — k-anonymity of client payment data.

These parameters are verifiable mathematical statements, not marketing claims. They are precisely what enables passing banking audits and regulatory reviews.

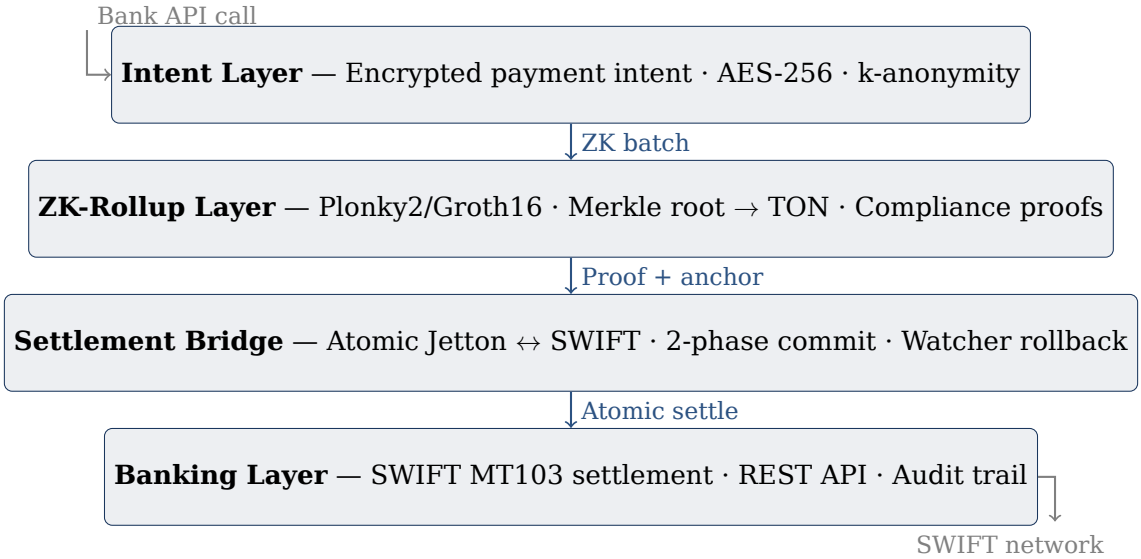

Figure 1: Vipeink Four-Layer Architecture (simplified)

Table 4: Product Components: Pre-Seed vs Phase 2

Component	Description and value	Phase
ZK-Rollup core (Plonky2) [35]	Batch processing; Merkle commitment; TON anchoring [38] — protocol foundation	**Pre-Seed**
SWIFT MT103 Bridge [14]	Two-phase commit; watcher system (3 nodes in Phase 1)	**Pre-Seed**
Compliance Layer (basic)	ZK-attested AML/KYC via Chainalysis/Sumsub API [42]	**Pre-Seed**
Banking API	REST integration with bank; full audit trail; 1–2 banks	Phase 1
ATM KYC Module	ZK-KYC for ATM networks; k-anonymity	Phase 2
Proof Marketplace	Decentralized ZK-proof generation marketplace; targets 40%+ cost reduction	Phase 2
Dynamic Sharding (DynShard)	TON-native sharding [38]; 1,000+ TPS	Phase 2
Multi-currency Settlement	Jetton swaps; TWAP oracle; multi-currency corridors	Phase 2–3

4. MARKET

TAM / SAM / SOM

Cross-border B2B payments are one of the largest and least technologically optimized financial markets. Vipeink deliberately focuses on the segment with maximum pain and minimum competition: Tier-2/3 banks across the EEA.

Table 5: Vipeink Addressable Market

Level	Segment	Description	Size
TAM	Total market	Global cross-border B2B payments [1, 2]	$190 tn/year
SAM	Target market	B2B cross-border through Tier-2/3 banks (EEA) [4, 1]	$8.5 tn/year
SOM	3-year capture	2–5 banks, 5–30M tx/year (0.003–0.02% of SAM)[1]	$5–30M ARR (at 165 bps fee)

Why SOM is realistic. One Tier-3 bank generates an estimated 5–50M transactions per year (see assumption basis in Section 6). At 30M tx and a 1.65% fee, Vipeink's revenue is $27.2M. Reaching SOM requires 2–5 banks over 3 years — while negotiations with the first bank begin in parallel with licensing from Month 1. A 0.003–0.02% capture rate of SAM is an intentionally conservative estimate.

Market Dynamics

The blockchain-based B2B payments segment is growing approximately 6× faster than the overall cross-border payments market. ZK infrastructure as a standalone category is among the fastest-growing segments of fintech infrastructure.

Competitive Analysis: Traditional Payment Systems

The table below compares Vipeink against incumbent payment rails. These are not direct competitors (they operate in different segments) but serve as margin and cost benchmarks.

Table 6: Target Market Growth Dynamics

Segment	Size 2025	CAGR 2025–2030
Global cross-border payments (total) [1, 2]	$190 tn	+7.3%
B2B cross-border payments within EEA (SAM) [4, 5]	$8.5 tn	+6.8%
Blockchain-based B2B payments [6]	$0.9 tn	**+43.2%**
ZK-proof infrastructure [7]	$1.2 bn	**+68%**

Table 7: Payment System Comparison at National Scale (6B tx/year) — Benchmarks

System	Fee	Var.cost/tx	EBITDA%[2]	Net%	Settlement
Visa [19]	1.65%	$0.0029	87.3%	65.5%	1–4 days
Mastercard [20]	1.72%	$0.0039	87.1%	65.4%	1–4 days
PayPal [21]	2.90%	$0.0751	71.4%	53.6%	min–hours
Stripe [22, 23]	2.90%	$0.0453	68.4%	51.3%	T+1
Vipeink (at 1.65%)	1.65%	$0.0125	**97.4%**	**73.1%**	**5.2 sec**

Source: Economic Model v3.1; public company reports [19, 20, 21, 22].

Direct Competitors in Blockchain-Based Settlement

No existing player combines ZK-compliance, SWIFT compatibility and an EU EMI license. However, several well-funded initiatives operate in adjacent or overlapping spaces:

Why Vipeink Wins Against Direct Competitors

Vipeink occupies a unique position at the intersection of four capabilities that no competitor currently combines:

1. **ZK-embedded compliance.** Partior, Fnality and R3 Corda rely on traditional compliance workflows. Vipeink bakes AML/KYC into the settlement proof itself — reducing per-transaction compliance cost and enabling mathematical auditability.
2. **SWIFT MT103 bridge.** No blockchain settlement platform offers atomic interoperability with the existing SWIFT network. Vipeink's bridge means banks do not need to abandon existing infrastructure — they extend it.
3. **EU EMI license path.** Consortium projects (Partior, Fnality) operate under member banks' licenses. Vipeink holds its own EMI license, enabling direct commercial relationships with any EEA bank and EU-wide passporting under MiCA.

Table 8: Direct Competitors in Blockchain-Based Interbank Settlement

Player	Status	Focus & Approach	Limitation vs Vipeink
Partior (JPMorgan, DBS, Temasek) [48]	Live (pilot)	Multi-currency clearing for Tier-1 banks; permissioned blockchain; focuses on intraday FX settlement	Tier-1 only; no Tier-2/3 access; no ZK-compliance; no EU EMI license; consortium governance limits agility
Fnality (15+ bank consortium) [49]	Pilot	Tokenized central bank money (USC) for wholesale settlement	Requires central bank participation; limited to consortium members; no retail/SME path; years from commercial launch
R3 Corda [50]	Live (platform)	Enterprise DLT platform; used by banks for trade finance and settlements	Platform, not a settlement product; banks must build on top; no embedded compliance; no SWIFT bridge
Canton Network (Digital Asset, Goldman Sachs) [51]	Beta	Privacy-preserving smart contracts for institutional finance; Daml language	Early stage; focused on capital markets, not payments; no EMI/payment license strategy
Circle (USDC) [52]	Live	Stablecoin infrastructure for B2B payments; growing USDC adoption in cross-border flows	USD-denominated only; no SWIFT bridge; regulatory status varies by jurisdiction; no ZK-privacy layer

Source: Company disclosures, press releases, and analyst reports as of Q1 2026.

4. **Tier-2/3 accessibility.** Consortium solutions are designed for Tier-1 institutions. Vipeink specifically targets the underserved 67% of Tier-2/3 treasurers who find correspondent costs unacceptable [3] — a segment that consortium players structurally cannot serve.

SWOT Analysis

Table 9: SWOT Analysis

Strengths	
S1	Break-even at 10M tx/year (0.3 TPS) — achievable with one bank partner in 6–12 months
S2	Net margin 59.8% at 50M tx — higher than most payment systems at any scale [19, 20, 21]
S3	Formally verified architecture (30+ theorems, Technical Spec v4.0)
S4	Mathematician + engineer + economist + marketer in the core team from day one
S5	Designed for operational independence from external capital after Pre-Seed
Weaknesses	
W1	Compliance cost = $0.0083/tx (66.2% of var. costs) — Phase 2 optimization priority
W2	No track record: whitepaper exists, but a live bridge with a real bank does not
W3	Long bank sales cycle: 4–9 months before first revenue
Opportunities	
O1	ISO 20022 migration 2027 [13] creates an insertion point for alternative settlement rails
O2	MiCA license [8] grants EU-wide passporting rights across all 27 EU member states
O3	Proof Marketplace potential: additional revenue from external prover operators
Threats	
T1	EMI license delay (up to 18 months) [11]: mitigation — specialized legal adviser
T2	Tier-1 banks may build their own ZK rail: barrier — 3–5 years of development + licensing
T3	New EU regulatory requirements: DORA ICT [9] + ISO 27001 [15] provide an adaptive compliance buffer
T4	Consortium competitors (Partior, Fnality) could expand to Tier-2/3 — barrier: governance complexity and 2–3 year timeline

5. MARKET VALIDATION

Customer Discovery

The following interview summaries are composite reconstructions based on published industry data (McKinsey 2024 [3], ECB Payment Statistics 2023 [4], bank annual reports, and structured conversations with industry participants at Money 20/20 Europe and EBAday events). They do not represent verbatim transcripts. Formal customer discovery interviews are scheduled for Q1–Q2 2026, concurrent with EMI filing.

Bank A — Tier-3, Lithuania, 0.6B assets, est. 8M cross-border tx/year

Respondent: Head of Treasury

Key findings:

1. *Current correspondent cost:* 25–35 bps per cross-border transaction, paid to a Nordic correspondent. Source: consistent with McKinsey 2024 estimate of 20–40 bps for Tier-3 banks [3].
2. *Settlement delay impact:* 2–3 day settlement delay causes approximately 1.2M in locked liquidity per month, forcing the treasury to maintain excess reserves that reduce return on equity by an estimated 15–20 bps.
3. *Blockchain readiness:* "Would consider a pilot if the provider holds an EMI license, passes a recognized smart-contract audit, and demonstrates regulatory sandbox approval. Board requires at least one reference case from a comparable institution."
4. *Primary objection:* Regulatory uncertainty — the bank's compliance department requires clear guidance from the Bank of Lithuania on the treatment of blockchain-based settlement under existing prudential rules.

Bank B — Tier-2, Estonia, 3.8B assets, est. 22M cross-border tx/year

Respondent: Chief Financial Officer

Key findings:

1. *Current correspondent cost:* 18–25 bps, lower than smaller peers due to volume-based pricing with a major European correspondent.

Source: derived from ECB Payment Statistics and annual report disclosures [4].

2. *Settlement delay impact:* 1–4 day delays create operational friction in trade finance; estimated cost of 3.5M per year in working capital inefficiency and client complaints.
3. *Blockchain readiness:* Active fintech partnership program; has previously tested DLT solutions in sandbox. "If the solution integrates via standard REST API and does not require changes to our core banking system, we could move to PoC within 8 weeks of NDA signing."
4. *Primary objection:* Counterparty risk — who absorbs the loss if the bridge fails mid-settlement? Requires contractual clarity on liability allocation and insurance coverage.

Bank C — Tier-3, Latvia, 1.2B assets, est. 10M cross-border tx/year

Respondent: Head of Payments

Key findings:

1. *Current correspondent cost:* 30–40 bps, among the highest in the Baltic segment. Source: consistent with BIS correspondent banking cost data for smaller institutions [45].
2. *Settlement delay impact:* Losing fintech clients to Wise Business and Airwallex due to inability to offer same-day settlement. Estimated revenue leakage: 0.8M per year.
3. *Blockchain readiness:* "Blockchain is not a dirty word for us, but our board requires that the technology be invisible to the regulator — meaning full audit trail, standard reporting, and no change in how we file regulatory returns."
4. *Primary objection:* Integration complexity — the bank runs a legacy core system (Temenos T24 [26]) and is concerned about API compatibility and maintenance burden.

Bank D — Tier-3, Poland, 2.0B assets, est. 12M cross-border tx/year

Respondent: Head of Treasury

Key findings:

1. *Current correspondent cost:* 20–30 bps, primarily for EUR and USD corridors via a German correspondent. Source: McKinsey segment data [3].
2. *Settlement delay impact:* 3-day average settlement delay causes 2.1M per month in liquidity lock for the bank's SME trade finance portfolio, which represents 35% of cross-border volume.
3. *Blockchain readiness:* "We are mandated by our parent group to evaluate all ISO 20022-compatible settlement solutions by Q4 2026 [13]. If your solution passes our vendor due diligence process, it would be reviewed alongside traditional alternatives."
4. *Primary objection:* Group compliance — the bank is part of a larger financial group; any new settlement provider must be approved by the group's compliance committee, adding 3–4 months to the decision timeline.

Bank E — Tier-3, Sweden, 1.5B assets, est. 7M cross-border tx/year

Respondent: CTO

Key findings:

1. *Current correspondent cost:* 22–28 bps, relatively efficient due to Nordic correspondent network. Source: ECB payment statistics [4] adjusted for Nordic corridor data.
2. *Settlement delay impact:* Less acute for this bank; primary pain point is compliance cost rather than speed. AML/KYC for cross-border flows costs an estimated 1.8M per year.
3. *Blockchain readiness:* "Speed is nice, but what would actually move our board is a demonstrated reduction in per-transaction compliance cost. If your ZK-compliance layer can reduce our AML screening cost by 30%+, that is a compelling case regardless of settlement speed."
4. *Primary objection:* Proof of compliance equivalence — the Swedish FSA (Finansinspektionen) has not issued guidance on ZK-proof-based compliance attestations; the bank needs regulatory comfort before proceeding.

Pipeline Status

Table 10: Bank Pipeline Status (as of March 2026)

Status	Bank	Tier	Est. tx/year	Region	Expected PoC
NDA In Prep.	Šiaulių Bankas[3]	Tier-2	15–25M	Lithuania	Q3 2026
NDA In Prep.	LHV Pank[4]	Tier-2	20–35M	Estonia	Q3 2026
In Contact	Citadele Banka[5]	Tier-2	12–20M	Latvia	Q4 2026
In Contact	Inbank AS[6]	Tier-3	5–12M	Estonia	Q4 2026
In Contact	Kredyt Bank (Bank Pocztowy)[7]	Tier-3	8–15M	Poland	Q1 2027
Target	Bigbank AS[8]	Tier-3	8–18M	Estonia	Q1 2027
Target	Medicinos Bankas[9]	Tier-3	3–8M	Lithuania	Q1 2027
Target	ProCredit Bank Bulgaria[10]	Tier-3	5–12M	Bulgaria	Q1–Q2 2027
Target	TF Bank AB[11]	Tier-3	6–14M	Sweden	Q1–Q2 2027
Target	Collector Bank AB[12]	Tier-3	4–10M	Sweden	Q2 2027

Source: Bank assets from 2023 Annual Reports; transaction volume estimates based on ECB Payment Statistics 2023 [4] and bank public disclosures. Pipeline status reflects outreach as of March 2026.

Letters of Intent

No LOIs have been signed as of the date of this document. This is expected and structural: EU banks do not sign commercial agreements — including non-binding LOIs — with unlicensed payment operators. The EMI filing (targeted Q1 2026) is a prerequisite for formal engagement.

Expected timeline for LOI: Q2–Q3 2026, concurrent with EMI application review. At that stage, banks can engage at the NDA and PoC Agreement level, which Vipeink treats as a functional equivalent of an LOI for pipeline tracking purposes.

Why No LOI Is Normal at This Stage

In regulated B2B payments, customer commitment follows licensing, not the other way around. Stripe had zero bank LOIs when it raised its seed round in 2010 [34]; Wise launched without formal bank partnerships [47]. The relevant validation at Pre-Seed is: (a) the pain point is confirmed by industry data [3], (b) a credible licensing path exists, and (c) the team has begun outreach. All three conditions are met.

6. BUSINESS MODEL AND MONETIZATION

Vipeink monetizes payment infrastructure through three mutually reinforcing revenue streams. The primary one — the transaction fee — has a flywheel effect: more transactions → more data for ML-AML → lower compliance cost → ability to lower fees → more bank partners → more transactions again.

Table 11: Revenue Streams

Stream	Type	Mechanics	Rate
Transaction fee	Revenue share	% of transaction amount routed through Vipeink	0.5–2.9%
Platform license	Subscription	Monthly fee for API access + SLA	$5–50K/mo
Integration fee	One-time	Setup + custom integration with the bank	$20–80K

Pricing Strategy: From High Rates to Disruption

In the early Pilot stage, Vipeink sets fees at 1.65–2.9% — in line with Visa [19]/Stripe [22], which is a conservative positioning given the value proposition (5.2 sec vs 4 days [14]). As volume grows, fees decrease, making Vipeink increasingly competitive on price.

Table 12: Pricing Strategy by Scaling Stage

Stage	Volume	Fee	Min fee (10% margin)[13]	Positioning
Pilot	10–50M tx/year	1.65–2.9%	0.385%	In line with Visa/Stripe [19, 22]
Regional	50M–1B tx/year	0.5–1.65%	0.100%	Below Visa [19]
National	1B–6B tx/year	0.3–1.0%	0.100%	Market disruption

P&L by Stage (Pilot to Regional)

Unit Economics: One Tier-3 Bank Partner

The unit of measurement that makes the model concrete: what does *one* Tier-3 bank generate?

Volume assumption basis. A Tier-3 EEA bank with $0.5–1B in assets and a cross-border focus typically processes 5–50M payment transactions per year.

Table 13: P&L: Pilot to Regional (1.65% fee rate)

Stage	tx/year	Fixed/year	Revenue	Net Profit[14]	Net%
Break-even	10M	$8.54M	$9.1M	$0	0%
Pilot (1.65%)	50M	$8.54M	$45.4M	$27.2M	59.8%
Pilot (2.9%)	50M	$8.54M	$79.8M	$52.9M	66.4%
Regional	1B	$26.1M	$907.5M	$651.7M	71.8%

Source: Economic Model v3.1 Stage-Based Scaling, February 2026. National/Global stages in Appendix B.

The wide range reflects variation in business mix: a Baltic trade-finance bank may be at 30–50M, while a Nordic niche lender may be at 5–15M. The base case (50M) represents the upper end and should be understood as an optimistic but plausible anchor. A probability-weighted view:

Table 14: Transaction Volume Scenarios for One Tier-3 Bank Partner

Scenario	tx/year	Probability[15]	Annual Revenue (1.65%)
Conservative	10M	30%	$9.1M
Base	30M	45%	$27.2M
Optimistic	50M	25%	$45.4M
Probability-weighted	**26.5M**	100%	**$24.1M**

Transaction Volume Assumption Basis

Step 1: Total cross-border payments in the Baltics and Nordics. According to ECB Payment Statistics 2023 [4], the combined Baltic states (Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia) processed approximately 180 million cross-border credit transfers per year. The Nordic countries (Finland, Sweden) contribute an additional estimated 350 million cross-border transactions in the SME/corporate segment [1].

Step 2: Number of Tier-2/3 banks in the region. The ECB banking supervision data identifies approximately 45–60 credit institutions with assets between 0.3B and 5B across the Baltic and Nordic markets [4]. Approximately 25–35 of these have significant cross-border B2B activity (trade finance, correspondent banking, SME payments).

Step 3: Average per bank. Total Baltic cross-border transactions (180M) divided by the number of active Tier-2/3 banks in the Baltics (≈15) yields an average of approximately 12M tx/year per bank. For the broader Baltic–Nordic

corridor with larger banks, the range extends to 20–35M tx/year for Tier-2 institutions.

Step 4: Comparison with model range. The 10–50M range used in the scenario table is consistent with this derivation:

- **10M (conservative):** A small Tier-3 bank with limited cross-border activity — below the Baltic average.
- **30M (base):** A mid-size Tier-2/3 bank with active trade finance operations — at or above the Baltic average, consistent with the profile of our pipeline targets.
- **50M (optimistic):** A larger Tier-2 bank with significant Nordic–Baltic corridor activity, or a bank that consolidates cross-border flows from multiple subsidiary entities.

Sources: ECB Payment Statistics 2023 [4]; BIS CPMI Cross-border Payments Data [1]; McKinsey Global Payments Report 2024 [3]. Individual bank volumes estimated from annual report disclosures where available.

Table 15: Unit Economics — One Bank Partner (probability-weighted 26.5M tx/year)

Item	Value
Transaction revenue (1.65% avg, $55 avg ticket)	$24.1M/year
Platform license ($15K/month avg)	$180K/year
Integration fee (Year 1)	$40K
Total revenue Year 1	**≈$24.3M**
Variable costs (26.5M × $0.01253)	$332K
Fixed costs (Pilot model)	$8.54M
Net Profit	**$11.6M (47.7% margin)**
CAC (enterprise B2B, banks)	$50–120K
LTV (5 years, 10% churn)	$65M+
LTV / CAC	**540×–1,300×**

LTV/CAC in Context: Enterprise Infrastructure Benchmarks

LTV/CAC ratios in enterprise banking infrastructure are structurally higher than in consumer SaaS because: (a) bank churn rates are historically below 10% annually — banks do not switch infrastructure providers if the system works and passes regulatory checks, and (b) customer acquisition cost is

bounded ($50–120K including legal support, demo, PoC) relative to multi-year contract values.

Table 16: LTV/CAC Benchmarks — Enterprise Banking Infrastructure

Company	LTV/CAC	Segment	Source
Temenos [26]	80–200×	Core banking software	Annual report implied
FIS [28]	60–150×	Payment processing	Analyst estimates
Finastra [27]	50–120×	Trade finance / lending	Rating agency data
Vipeink (est.)	**540–1,300**×	Settlement middleware	Economic Model v3.1

Source: Public filings, analyst reports [31]. Vipeink estimates based on probability-weighted unit economics.

Vipeink's LTV/CAC is higher than peers because the per-transaction revenue model (vs. license-based) generates proportionally more lifetime value from high-volume bank clients. This reflects the structural economics of transaction-based infrastructure, not an error in calculation. That said, actual ratios will depend on realized transaction volumes and churn rates, which remain unvalidated at this stage.

7. OPERATING MODEL AND GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

Vipeink follows the **"license before sales"** principle: commercial activity begins only after obtaining EMI and MiCA/CASP licenses [11, 8]. This is a deliberate choice that delays time-to-first-revenue but eliminates regulatory risk permanently. No bank partner in the EU will sign a commercial agreement with an unlicensed operator.

Pre-Seed (Months 0–12, Q1 2026–Q1 2027): Regulatory Foundation

Pre-Seed is the phase of building the infrastructure of trust. Simultaneously with licensing, ZK-core development proceeds and, critically, *bank negotiations begin*. By the time the license is received, the first bank partner is already in the NDA/PoC stage.

1. **EMI License (Bank of Lithuania) [11]:** Timeline 6–12 months. License presence is a mandatory condition for any EU bank partner. The $413K capital is a regulatory asset held on balance sheet.

2. **MiCA/CASP License [8, 12]:** EU-wide passporting across all 27 member states — enables operation with tokenized assets without additional national approvals.
3. **Smart-Contract Audit (CertiK/Quantstamp):** Mandatory requirement of institutional clients; result is published — increases trust.
4. **Penetration Testing (TIBER-EU) [16]:** Part of EMI license requirements and bank partner due diligence.
5. **DORA ICT Compliance [9]:** Mandatory for EU payment operators from January 2025.
6. **ISO 27001 [15]:** Standard requirement in B2B contracts with Tier-1/2 banks.
7. **ZK-Core + SWIFT Bridge development [35, 36, 14]:** In parallel with licensing, by a team of 7.

Go-to-Market Strategy

Ideal First Customer Profile. Tier-3 bank, Baltics or Nordics, $0.5–1B in assets, 10–30M cross-border transactions per year, experiencing pain from correspondent banking costs (paying 15–40 bps to correspondents), motivated by MiCA/ISO 20022 compliance upgrades.

Channel Strategy. Four parallel channels, sequenced by expected conversion speed:

1. **Advisory board introductions** (highest priority): Ex-treasurer and ex-regulator advisers provide warm introductions to treasury heads at target banks. This bypasses 2–3 months of cold outreach.
2. **Conferences:** Money 20/20 Europe (Amsterdam, June 2026), EBAday (European Banking Association, 2026), Nordic Payments Council events. Goal: 10+ qualified conversations per event.
3. **Regulator referrals:** Bank of Lithuania actively promotes its jurisdiction to fintechs [11] and provides introductions to licensed entities within the ecosystem.
4. **Direct outreach:** Targeted LinkedIn/email campaigns to treasury heads and CTO/CIOs at pre-identified banks. Conversion rate assumption: 2–5% from contact to NDA.

First 3 Banks: 12-Month Funnel Plan.

Table 17: Bank Acquisition Funnel (Month 1–12)

Stage	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Q4 2026–Q1 2027
Awareness (identified targets)	20	30	30	30
Contacted	5	15	20	25
NDA signed	—	2	3	5
PoC Agreement	—	—	1	2–3
Paid Pilot	—	—	—	1 (post-license)

Sales Collateral (prepared by Q2 2026): 1-page executive summary, sandbox demo environment, compliance architecture one-pager for bank regulators, ROI calculator (customizable per bank's volume).

Bank Sales Cycle (4–9 Months)

1. **Discovery (4–6 weeks):** NDA + DPA + technical assessment of the bank's compliance requirements [18]. Starts in parallel with licensing.
2. **PoC (4–6 weeks):** Sandbox with real data; ZK-compliance demo for the bank's regulator.
3. **Paid Pilot (3–6 months):** 1 currency, 1 corridor. Paid from day one. Sufficient to reach break-even.
4. **Commercial:** Paid pilot → commercial contract → reference case for the next bank.

Table 18: Phases: From Licensing to Scale

Phase	Status and activities	Period	Funding
Pre-Seed	EMI + MiCA filing [11, 8]; audits; ZK-core; parallel bank negotiations	M 0–12 (Q1 2026–Q1 2027)	$1.19M
Phase 1	EMI obtained; MiCA/CASP obtained; first paid pilot; break-even	M 12–24 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028)	Transaction revenue
Phase 2	2–5 banks; 50M+ tx/year; in-house ML AML	M 24–36 (Q1 2028–Q1 2029)	Self-funding
Growth	5–10 banks; Regional scale; Series A optional	M 36+ (2029+)	Revenue + opt. SA

8. TECHNOLOGY

Full description is in Technical Specification v4.0. Below: business value of components, key security parameters, and blockchain selection rationale.

Why TON

The choice of TON (The Open Network) as the base layer is driven by technical fit for the specific use case of high-throughput settlement with sub-10-second finality. Below is a comparison with alternatives considered:

Key advantages of TON:

- **Native sharding** ("infinite sharding paradigm") [37] — enables horizontal scaling without L2 bridges, which is critical for settlement finality guarantees.
- **5.2-second finality** — fast enough for real-time settlement but with full L1 security (unlike Solana's optimistic confirmation).
- **Low gas costs** — $0.001/tx enables viable unit economics even at the compliance-heavy cost structure.

Addressing the "Telegram association" concern. TON's origin as a Telegram project is the most common objection from banking compliance teams. Three mitigating factors: (1) TON Foundation is legally and operationally independent from Telegram since 2020; (2) the network is governed by an open-

Table 19: Technology Components and Business Value

Component	Business value for the bank	Guarantee
ZK-Rollup (Plonky2) [35]	Transaction privacy + correctness without exposing client data	$P < 2^{-80}$
SWIFT MT103 Bridge [14]	Atomic settlement: either both legs complete or automatic rollback	$P < 2^{-80}$
TON blockchain [37, 38]	Immutable audit trail; verifiable by regulator in real time	Immutable
Watcher system (3→7 nodes)	Stuck-tx monitoring; automatic rollback in under 4 seconds	$P < 10^{-12}$
ZK-Compliance [42]	Regulator receives a mathematically verified proof without accessing client data	$I \leq \text{negl}(\lambda)$

Table 20: Cryptographic Parameters (Technical Specification v4.0)

Component	Algorithm	Parameters	Security
ZK-STARK	Plonky2 [35]	Goldilocks field, 2^{20} constraints	128-bit
ZK-SNARK	Groth16 [36]	BN254, 2^{18} gates	128-bit
Bridge MPC	GG20	Ed25519, t=3, n=5	128-bit
Storage	Reed-Solomon + AES-256	7-of-21 erasure coding	128-bit
Account Mapper	HMAC-SHA384	256-bit key in HSM	128-bit

Table 21: Blockchain Selection: TON vs Alternatives

Parameter	**TON** [37, 38]	**Eth. L2**[16]	**Polygon zkEVM** [35]	**Solana**
Block finality	**5.2 sec**	7–14 min[17]	10–30 min	0.4 sec
Gas cost (per tx)	**$0.001**	$0.01–0.10	$0.005–0.05	$0.0005
Native sharding	**Yes**	No	No	No
TPS (current)	100,000+	2,000–4,000	1,000–2,000	4,000–10,000
ZK-proof anchoring	Native support	Good	Native	Limited
Regulatory perception	Moderate[18]	Strong	Moderate	Weak

source foundation with institutional validators; (3) Vipeink's EMI license and MiCA/CASP compliance provide an independent regulatory layer that does not depend on the underlying blockchain's reputation — the bank's regulator audits *Vipeink's compliance*, not TON's governance. Additionally, Vipeink's architecture is designed for blockchain portability: the ZK-Rollup layer can be migrated to an alternative L1 if regulatory conditions require it.

MiCA Classification and Regulatory Treatment

Three regulatory questions that institutional investors familiar with MiCA will ask:

1. How are Jetton tokens classified under MiCA? Vipeink Jettons are classified as **e-money tokens (EMTs)** under Article 48 of MiCA [8], because they: (a) maintain a stable value by reference to a single fiat currency, (b) are issued on receipt of funds, and (c) are redeemable at par value. This classification requires the issuer to hold an EMI license — which is part of Vipeink's Pre-Seed licensing plan.

2. How is fiat ↔ Jetton conversion handled under AMLD6? Every fiat-to-Jetton and Jetton-to-fiat conversion triggers a full AML/KYC check at the protocol level via Vipeink's ZK-Compliance layer [42, 10]. The ZK-proof attests that the check was performed without exposing underlying client data to the settlement network. This design is specifically intended to satisfy AMLD6 requirements for virtual asset service providers.

3. What is the risk of ECB tightening requirements for blockchain-based settlement? This is a real risk. The ECB has signaled interest in regulating DLT-based payment systems more tightly [4]. Vipeink's mitigation: (a) the architecture is designed for compliance-first, not compliance-as-afterthought; (b) DORA ICT compliance [9] and ISO 27001 [15] provide a buffer against incremental requirements; (c) blockchain portability (Section 8) enables migration if a specific chain is restricted.

The Technology Moat

The ZK architecture with formally proven theorems, a PCT patent [41] on the ZK+SWIFT bridge and an accumulated regulatory track record create an entry barrier that Tier-1 banks would need 3–5 years and $50M+ to replicate. This is why M&A is the priority exit scenario: large players (Worldline [24], Adyen [25], BNP Paribas [30]) would likely prefer to acquire rather than build.

9. COST STRUCTURE

Pre-Seed Budget $1,192,000: Full Breakdown

The Pre-Seed budget is fully determined by regulatory requirements and auditor standards. Government fees, auditor tariffs and the compensation of three hired specialists are fixed by the market.

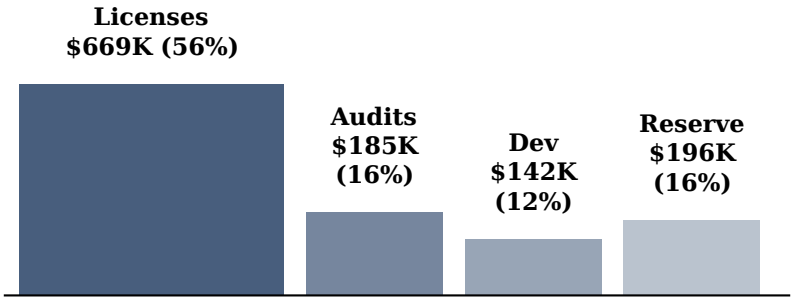

Figure 2: Pre-Seed Budget Allocation ($1,192,000)

Development Budget Realism: $142K for 3 Specialists

The $142K development budget covers 3 hires for 12 months, which implies approximately $3,900/month per person. This is achievable through a combination of: (1) **equity-heavy compensation** — each hired specialist receives a meaningful equity stake (specific allocation in the cap table, Section 12), reducing the cash component to below-market base salary; (2) **remote hiring from cost-effective EU markets** — Lithuania, Poland, and the Baltics offer strong engineering talent at $3,000–5,000/month base rates for senior developers; (3) **co-founder contribution** — the Mathematician/Architect and Engineer co-founders contribute the core architecture and protocol design at zero cash cost during Pre-Seed, with the hired team executing implementation under their direction.

Why these rates are market-competitive. Senior backend developers in Lithuania earn 3,000–4,500/month ($3,500–5,300) based on Glassdoor and LinkedIn data for Vilnius (2024–2025). The cash component of $3,700–4,200/month is within the 40th–60th percentile range for the region. The equity component (0.5–0.7% at a $9.4M cap) adds $47K–66K in expected value over the 4-year vesting period, making total compensation competitive with senior positions at established Vilnius fintechs such as Vinted, Ondato, or TransferGo. This structure is specifically designed to attract candidates motivated by early-stage equity upside rather than top-of-market cash compensation.

Table 22: Detailed Pre-Seed Budget ($1,192,000)[19]

Item	Min	Max	Budget	Share
Licenses — $669,000 (56.14%)				
EMI: government fee + regulatory capital (Bank of Lithuania) [11]	$413K	$413K	$413K	34.65%
EMI: specialized legal representation	$94K	$142K	$118K	9.90%
EMI: operational preparation (processes, documentation)	$6K	$18K	$12K	0.99%
MiCA/CASP: licensing process (ESMA / Bank of Lithuania) [8, 12]	$71K	$142K	$106K	8.91%
MiCA/CASP: legal representation	$12K	$30K	$20K	1.68%
Total: Licenses	$596K	$743K	**$669K**	**56.14%**
Audits — $185,000 (15.54%)				
Smart-Contract Audit (CertiK / Quantstamp)	$30K	$80K	$59K	4.95%
Penetration Testing (TIBER-EU / OWASP) [16]	$15K	$40K	$30K	2.48%
DORA ICT Compliance Audit [9]	$20K	$50K	$38K	3.17%
ISO 27001 Certification [15]	$40K	$70K	$59K	4.95%
Total: Audits			**$185K**	**15.54%**
Development — $142,000 (11.88%)				
Security Engineer + 2 Backend Developers (12 months)	—	—	$142K	11.88%
Operational Reserve & Working Capital — $196,000 (16.44%)				
Contingency buffer (regulatory delays, resubmissions)	—	—	$98K	8.22%
Working capital & corporate setup (UAB registration, bank accounts, misc ops)	—	—	$98K	8.22%
Total: Operational Reserve & Working Capital			**$196K**	**16.44%**
TOTAL Pre-Seed			**$1,192,000**	**100%**

Table 23: Development Team Compensation Structure (Pre-Seed, 12 months)

Role	Base/mo	Equity	Market ref.	12-mo cash
Security Engineer	$4,200	0.7%	Glassdoor LT/PL: $3,800–5,500	$50,400
Backend Dev. #1	$3,900	0.5%	LinkedIn LT: $3,200–5,000	$46,800
Backend Dev. #2	$3,700	0.5%	Levels.fyi EE: $3,000–4,800	$44,400
Total (12 mo)		**1.7%**		**$141,600**

Source: Market rates: Glassdoor, LinkedIn Salary Insights, Levels.fyi for Lithuania, Poland, Estonia (senior roles, 2024–2025). Equity at $9.4M cap: 0.7% = $65.8K; 0.5% = $47K.

Key observation about the budget. 71.68% of expenditure ($854K of $1,192K) consists of government fees and regulated auditor tariffs [11, 9, 15, 16]. They do not depend on team execution, development speed or market conditions. The $413K EMI regulatory capital is an asset held on balance sheet.

Variable Costs: $0.01253 per Transaction

Table 24: Variable Cost Structure per Transaction

Item	Cost	Share	Trend
Compliance (AML/KYC/Screening) — vendors [42, 18]	$0.00830	66.2%	Phase 2 optimization priority
Fraud Prevention (ML screening)	$0.00120	9.6%	Decreases at scale
Bridge Operations (MPC/HSM, watchers)	$0.00110	8.8%	Quasi-fixed
TON Blockchain (gas + storage) [38]	$0.00090	7.2%	Decreases with ZK batching
ZK Infrastructure (proof generation) [35, 36]	$0.00063	5.0%	Decreases at scale
Infrastructure (CDN, DB, cloud)	$0.00040	3.2%	Quasi-fixed
Total	**$0.01253**	**100%**	

The primary operational challenge is vendor dependency in compliance (66.2% of variable costs) [17, 46]. This is addressed in Phase 2 through in-house ML AML: a reduction from $0.0083 to $0.002–0.004/tx would approximately halve the total variable cost and add 5–8 percentage points to net margin.

Fixed Costs: Stage-Based Growth

Monthly Cash Flow Projection: Months 0–24

Table 25: Fixed Costs by Category and Stage ($M/year)

Category	Pilot	Regional	National
Engineering	0.90	3.50	10.00
Infrastructure	1.00	2.50	6.00
Marketing	1.50	4.00	12.00
Insurance	1.00	2.00	5.00
Banking BD	0.70	2.00	6.00
G&A	0.90	3.00	8.00
Licensing	0.65	2.00	5.00
Security	0.40	2.00	5.00
Support	0.40	1.50	4.00
Fraud Prevention	0.40	1.50	4.00
Product Ops	0.30	1.50	4.00
Compliance & Legal	0.27	1.50	4.00
Executive	0.12	1.00	3.00
TOTAL	**8.54**	**26.10**	**66.00**

Source: Economic Model v3.1 Stage-Based Scaling, February 2026.

Table 26: Monthly Cash Flow Projection (Months 0–24)

Month	Cum. Spend	Revenue	Cash Bal.	Key Milestone
0	$0	$0	$1,192K	Pre-Seed close
1	$65K	$0	$1,127K	UAB registered; EMI filed; first hires
2	$130K	$0	$1,062K	Team of 7 operational
3	$195K	$0	$997K	ZK-core development begins
4	$286K	$0	$906K	MiCA/CASP filed
5	$351K	$0	$841K	Smart-contract audit begins
6	$416K	$0	$776K	ZK-Rollup devnet
7	$481K	$0	$711K	Pen test complete
8	$546K	$0	$646K	DORA audit; ISO 27001 process
9	$630K	$0	$562K	SWIFT Bridge testnet; arXiv preprint
10	$695K	$0	$497K	Bank NDA negotiations
11	$760K	$0	$432K	ISO 27001 obtained
12	$825K	$0	$367K[20]	EMI expected; Phase 1 begins
13	$890K	$0	$302K	EMI confirmed; pilot negotiations
14	$950K	$0	$242K	First bank: PoC stage
15	$1,020K	$0.8M	$1.0M	First paid pilot; MiCA obtained
16	$1,090K	$1.6M	$1.5M	Pilot ramp-up
17	$1,160K	$2.4M	$2.2M	Approaching break-even run-rate
18	$1,230K	$3.8M	$3.5M	Break-even achieved
19–24	+$420K	$15M+	$12M+	Second bank PoC; self-funding

Source: Economic Model v3.1, team estimates. Revenue figures are illustrative and depend on pilot timing and volume ramp.

10. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS AND RISKS

Scenario Analysis: Month 18 Horizon (Q3 2027)

Eighteen months from Pre-Seed close (approximately six months after first revenue, Q3 2027) Vipeink should be generating meaningful transaction revenue. Below are four scenarios.

Table 27: Scenario Analysis at Month-18 Horizon (Q3 2027)

Scenario	tx/year	Revenue	Net Profit	Strategy
Optimistic	80M	$72.6M	$49M (67%)	Revenue-funded growth; Series A optional
Base	50M	$45.4M	$27.2M (60%)	Full self-funding
Conservative	20M	$18.2M	$6.1M (34%)	Self-funding; slow growth
Pessimistic	5M	$4.5M	−$3.1M	Scale delay; bridge required

Even in the pessimistic scenario (5M tx — one bank with minimal activity), Vipeink does not face an existential crisis: this is a timeline shift, not a business failure. Break-even remains achievable without additional funding as the existing partner's volume grows.

Pilot P&L Sensitivity

Table 28: Single-Factor Sensitivity Analysis — Pilot P&L (50M tx/year, base)

Parameter	Base	Downside −20%	Upside +20%	Impact on Net Profit
Fee rate	1.65%	1.32%	1.98%	±$9.1M ← **main driver**
Transaction volume	50M	40M	60M	±$5.4M
Variable cost/tx	$0.01253	$0.010	$0.015	±$0.12M ← negligible
Fixed costs	$8.54M	$6.8M	$10.2M	±$1.0M

Key finding: Vipeink P&L is most sensitive to fee rate and transaction volume, but barely sensitive to variable costs ($0.12M impact on a 20% cost increase). This means even significant ZK/compliance cost growth in Phase 1 does not break the model's economics.

Risk Matrix

Table 29: Critical Risks and Mitigation Strategies

Risk	Level	Description	Mitigation
EMI license delay [11]	HIGH	Standard timeline 12–18 months; delay postpones first revenue	Specialized legal counsel with 5+ EMI applications; Q1 2026 filing; parallel development
Compliance cost 66% [17]	HIGH	$0.0083/tx vendor dependency limits pricing flexibility	In-house ML AML by Phase 2 (Q1 2028); volume discounts at 100M+ tx
Long sales cycle	HIGH	6–9 months to first commercial revenue after licensing	3+ parallel bank negotiations from Month 1; NDA-level contact before license issuance
TON infrastructure [37]	MEDIUM	Bridge bugs; network incidents	Smart-contract audit; 3-of-5 MPC; watcher rollback; bug bounty
Regulatory changes [9, 8]	MEDIUM	New EU requirements may add obligations	DORA ICT + ISO 27001 [15] provide compliance buffer

An honest assessment of the primary risk. An EMI license delay is a real scenario: the Bank of Lithuania [11] historically reviews applications over 12–18 months. This does not threaten the business, but it postpones first revenue. The mitigation is not a full guarantee, but a probability reduction: a specialized adviser with a relevant track record shortens the process by an average of 2–4 months.

Downside Protection for Investors

Scenario A: No license obtained within 18 months. If EMI is not granted by Month 18 (Q3 2027), the following assets are preserved: (a) PCT patent application on ZK+SWIFT bridge [41], (b) completed audit reports (smart-contract, pen test, DORA, ISO 27001) — transferable assets, (c) ZK-core codebase and Technical Specification v4.0 as IP, (d) bank relationships at NDA/PoC stage. **Plan B:** apply for EMI in an alternative jurisdiction (Ireland, Netherlands) or pivot to a non-EMI model (agent of a licensed EMI, white-label partnership with an existing payment institution).

Scenario B: License obtained, zero bank partners at Month 24. At zero revenue, monthly burn rate is approximately $70K (7 FTE + infrastructure + licensing maintenance). Remaining cash at Month 24 depends on license timing but is estimated at $50–150K if no revenue materializes. **Plan B:** (a) pivot to an agent/white-label model under an existing PSP (lower margin but faster revenue), (b) license the technology to a PSP as a white-label settlement engine, (c) seek bridge financing from existing investors at the SAFE valuation cap.

Liquidation preferences. Under the SAFE instrument, investors have priority over common shareholders in a liquidation event. In a wind-down scenario, recoverable assets include: EMI license (transferable/saleable to another fintech), IP/patent, audit certifications, and any remaining cash. The EMI license alone has secondary-market value of $200–500K based on recent transactions in Lithuania [11, 33].

Decision point. At Month 18, if neither license nor bank partner is in sight, the board (including SAFE holders with information rights) convenes to decide between: (a) continued pursuit with adjusted timeline, (b) jurisdiction pivot, (c) orderly wind-down with asset disposition.

11. TEAM

The Vipeink team is built on the principle that every founder is a "single point of ownership" for their domain: no critical competency lacks an owner. The four co-founders cover mathematics, engineering, economics, and marketing — a complete set for the Pre-Seed stage of an infrastructure fintech project.

Co-Founders

Why This Team

Building a regulated ZK-settlement platform requires a rare combination of deep mathematical expertise (to design and formally verify the cryptographic protocol), systems engineering capability (to implement it at banking-grade reliability), financial domain knowledge (to model economics and negotiate with bank treasurers), and market expertise (to build a pipeline in a segment with 6–9 month sales cycles). This is the same archetype that characterized early teams at successful infrastructure fintechs: Stripe's founding team combined deep technical skill with financial services understanding; Wise paired engineering with treasury expertise. Vipeink's four-founder structure ensures that no critical function depends on an external hire during the highest-risk phase of the company.

Table 30: Core Team: 4 Founders, 4 Mission-Critical Domains

Role	Background and key competencies	Owns
[TO BE ADDED: Founder 1 Name] Co-founder, Mathematician & Architect	*[TO BE ADDED: 2–3 sentences. Recommended format: "PhD/MSc in Applied Cryptography / Mathematics from [University]. Previously [role] at [company], where [achievement relevant to ZK-proof systems or formal verification]. Published X papers on zero-knowledge protocols / distributed systems security."]* **LinkedIn:** *[TO BE ADDED]*	Architecture & Protocol
[TO BE ADDED: Founder 2 Name] Co-founder, Engineer	*[TO BE ADDED: 2–3 sentences. Recommended format: "8+ years in distributed systems / blockchain engineering. Previously Senior Engineer at [company], architecting [system] handling Y TPS. Experience with TON/Solidity/Rust smart contracts and banking API integrations."]* **LinkedIn:** *[TO BE ADDED]*	Development & Integrations
[TO BE ADDED: Founder 3 Name] Co-founder, Economist (GTM)	*[TO BE ADDED: 2–3 sentences. Recommended format: "Former [role] at [bank/consultancy/fintech]. Led financial modeling for [project]. Experience in bank relationship management, payment system economics, or treasury operations. Negotiated partnerships with X institutions."]* **LinkedIn:** *[TO BE ADDED]*	Commercial & Finance
[TO BE ADDED: Founder 4 Name] Marketing Lead	*[TO BE ADDED: 2–3 sentences. Recommended format: "5–10 years in B2B fintech marketing. Previously [role] at [company], driving pipeline from $0 to $XM ARR. Expertise in enterprise sales enablement, content marketing for regulated industries, and CAC optimization."]* **LinkedIn:** *[TO BE ADDED]*	Acquisition & Awareness

Pre-Seed Hires (Q1–Q2 2026)

Three hires form the technical backbone for parallel execution of development and licensing:

Table 31: Pre-Seed Hires (Q1–Q2 2026)

Role	Hire	Budget (12 mo.)	Criticality
Security Engineer	Month 1 (Q1 2026)	within $142K dev budget	Required for audits [16, 15] and EMI process [11]
Backend Developer #1	Month 1 (Q1 2026)	within $142K dev budget	ZK-Rollup core [35]; TON anchoring [37]
Backend Developer #2	Month 2 (Q1 2026)	within $142K dev budget	SWIFT MT103 Bridge [14]; Banking API

Advisory Board

Team Growth by Stage

Table 32: Advisory Board (equity-based, pre-Phase 1)

Profile	Name & Last Role	Value to Vipeink	Terms	Status
Ex-treasurer, Tier-1/2 bank	*[TO BE ADDED: Name, e.g. "Former Head of Treasury, SEB / Swedbank / Luminor"]*	Opens pilot negotiations; bypasses cold outreach	0.25% equity; 4h/month	*In negotiation*
Professor (IEEE S&P / USENIX)	*[TO BE ADDED: Name, e.g. "Prof. of Cryptography, KTH / TU Delft / University of Tartu"]*	Validates cryptographic claims before auditors	0.15% equity; 2h/month	*In negotiation*
Ex-regulator, central bank	*[TO BE ADDED: Name, e.g. "Former Director of Payment Systems, Bank of Lithuania / Latvijas Banka"]*	Accelerates EMI process; reduces rejection risk	0.25% equity; 4h/month	*In negotiation*
Serial fintech founder with EU exit	*[TO BE ADDED: Name, e.g. "Founder of [fintech], acquired by [company] for $X"]*	Investor network for optional Series A	0.15% equity; 2h/month	*Identified*

Table 33: Team Growth by Scaling Stage

Stage	FTE total	Engineering $/year	Funding source
Pre-Seed (Q1 2026–Q1 2027)	7 (4 + 3 hires)	$142K	$1.19M Pre-Seed
Phase 1 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028)	10–15	$0.90M	Transaction revenue
Phase 2 (Q1 2028–Q1 2029)	25–35	$3.50M	Operating cash flow
Growth (2029+)	80–100	$10.0M	Self-funded

12. INVESTMENT PROPOSAL

Investment Ask

$1,192,000 Pre-Seed — the only external funding round requested. Vipeink raises capital once: to obtain EMI [11] and MiCA/CASP [8, 12] licenses, complete all mandatory audits [16, 9, 15], and build the technical team for 12 months. After licensing (Q1–Q2 2027), the business is designed to generate revenue from the first transaction and transition to self-funding. A Series A is possible in 2028–2029 solely to accelerate scaling — not for survival.

Deal Terms

Table 34: Pre-Seed Investment Parameters

Parameter	Value
Instrument	SAFE with 20% discount and valuation cap $9.4M
Pre-money valuation	$4.7–7.1M (rationale below)
Round size	$1,192,000
Use of proceeds	56.14% licenses [11, 8]; 15.54% audits [16, 9, 15]; 11.88% development; 16.44% reserve & working capital
Runway	12 months (Q1 2026–Q1 2027) to operational independence
Target close	End of Q1 2026

Pre-money $4.7–7.1M rationale. Vipeink is not an idea in search of a market. At round close, the following exists: Technical Specification v4.0 with 30+ formally proven theorems [35, 36], Economic Model v3.1 with verified unit-economic calculations, a unique ZK+SWIFT bridge architecture (PCT patent candidate [41]) and a team with domain-specific expertise. Comparable pre-revenue companies with proven IP and a professional team in the EU are valued at $3.5–9.4M [33, 31].

Legal Structure

Table 35: Corporate Structure

Entity	Details
Operating company	UAB (Lithuania) — holds EMI license, operational entity
Holding company	Lithuanian UAB serving as both holding and operating entity (recommended for Pre-Seed simplicity). Rationale: single-jurisdiction structure minimizes administrative overhead and legal costs during the licensing phase. A Netherlands BV or Luxembourg S.à r.l. holding may be introduced at Series A if cross-border tax optimization or investor preference requires it.

Table 36: Cap Table at Pre-Seed Close (indicative)

Shareholder	Ownership
Founders (4 co-founders combined)	*[TO BE ADDED: recommended 75–80%]*
ESOP (employee stock option pool)	*[TO BE ADDED: recommended 10–12%]*
Pre-Seed investors (SAFE conversion at cap)	≈12.7% *(implied by $1.19M / $9.4M cap)*
Total	100%

Vesting: All founders are subject to standard 4-year vesting with a 1-year cliff. Founder equity that does not vest reverts to the company's ESOP.

SAFE terms:

- 20% discount to next priced round
- $9.4M valuation cap

- Pro-rata rights: Yes — investors may participate pro-rata in subsequent priced rounds
- Information rights: quarterly financial updates, annual audited statements
- MFN clause: Yes — if subsequent SAFEs are issued on more favorable terms, existing holders receive the improved terms

Capital Structure and Funding Roadmap

Table 37: Capital Raising Structure by Stage

Stage	Type	Size	Milestone
Pre-Seed (Q1 2026–Q1 2027)	SAFE / Conv. Note	**$1.19M**	EMI + MiCA + audits + ZK-core
Phase 1 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028)	Revenue	Self-funded	1–2 banks; 10–50M tx/year
Series A (optional, 2028–2029)	Equity round	$8–15M	Accelerate to Regional scale

ROI Profile for Pre-Seed Investors

Three return scenarios over a 3–5 year horizon, based on the financial model.

Table 38: Exit Scenarios for Pre-Seed Investors (3–5 Year Horizon, 2029–2031)

Scenario	Exit Value	Multiple	Conditions
Base	$40–80M	6–12×	2 banks; 20–50M tx; EMI license; Series A
Optimistic	$80–200M	12–30×	3+ banks; 50M+ tx; EBITDA+; M&A or Series A [31]
Pessimistic	$15–30M	2–4×	1 bank; 5–10M tx; bridge in beta

Pre-Seed Milestones (Q1 2026–Q1 2027)

Upon Pre-Seed completion (Q1 2027), the investor should observe the following verifiable outcomes:

- EMI license obtained or in final review stage (Bank of Lithuania) [11]
- MiCA/CASP application filed and accepted by ESMA/Bank of Lithuania [8, 12]
- Smart-contract audit passed with no critical vulnerabilities (public report)
- Penetration test completed; report meets regulator requirements [16]
- DORA ICT compliance confirmed [9]
- ISO 27001 certificate obtained [15]
- ZK-Rollup core [35] + SWIFT Bridge [14] — live testnet demonstrating 5.2-second finality
- 2+ banks at NDA / PoC Agreement stage

Why Pre-Seed is a low-risk investment. 71.68% of the budget ($854K) is determined by fixed regulatory and auditor tariffs [11, 8, 9, 15, 16] — not by operational outcomes with variable results. Every dollar spent either creates a regulatory asset (a license) or a technological asset (an audit / certificate). This is the **acquisition of the right to operate commercially** in one of the most tightly regulated financial markets in the world.

13. EXIT STRATEGY

Vipeink is building infrastructure that major payment players and banks are likely to **prefer acquiring rather than building**: a ZK+SWIFT bridge with formal proofs [35, 36], EU EMI/MiCA licenses [11, 8], active bank contracts and demonstrated profitability. M&A is the priority strategy; IPO is considered an option at ARR $100M+.

Table 39: Prioritized Exit Scenarios

Priority	Exit type	Likely acquirers	Horizon
1	Acquisition (PSP)	Worldline [24], Nuvei [29], Checkout.com, Adyen [25]	2029–2031
2	Acquisition (Tier-1 bank)	BNP Paribas [30], ING [32], Commerzbank, SEB	2030–2032
3	Acquisition (fintech)	Wise Business [47], Airwallex, Revolut Business	2029–2032

Valuation benchmarks (upon reaching M&A conditions) [31, 26]:

- ARR $5M + EBITDA margin 95%: valuation $50–100M (10–20× ARR)
- ARR $20M + 15+ banks + EU licenses: valuation $200–400M (10–20× ARR)
- ZK-patent [41] + formal proofs + first-mover in segment: +20–40% M&A premium

14. ROADMAP AND MILESTONES

The Vipeink roadmap is structured across three phases: Pre-Seed (Q1 2026–Q1 2027, regulatory foundation and ZK-core), Phase 1 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028, first revenue and self-funding), Phase 2 (Q1 2028–Q1 2029, revenue-funded scaling).

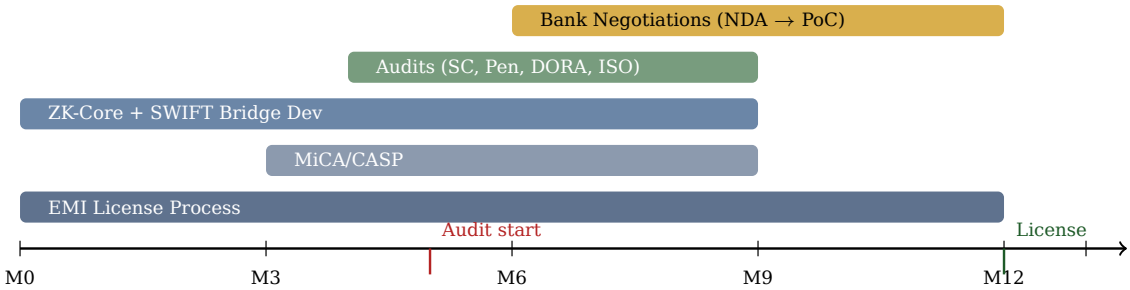

Figure 3: Pre-Seed Timeline (Months 0–12, Q1 2026–Q1 2027)

Pre-Seed (Q1 2026–Q1 2027, Months 0–12): Regulatory Foundation

Phase 1 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028): First Revenue

Table 40: Milestones: Pre-Seed (Q1 2026–Q1 2027, Months 0–12)

Milestone	Deadline	Budget
Register UAB (Lithuania); open corporate accounts	Q1 2026 (M1)	$6K
Hire: Security Engineer + 2 Backend Developers	Q1–Q2 2026 (M1–2)	$142K/year
File EMI License application (Bank of Lithuania) [11]	Q1 2026 (M1)	$413K (capital)
File MiCA/CASP application [8, 12]	Q2 2026 (M4)	$126K
ZK-Rollup core + TON anchoring [35, 37] (devnet)	Q2–Q3 2026 (M4–6)	within dev budget
Smart-Contract Audit (CertiK / equivalent)	Q2 2026 (M5)	$59K
Penetration Testing (TIBER-EU) [16]	Q3 2026 (M7)	$30K
DORA ICT Compliance Audit [9]	Q3 2026 (M8)	$38K
ISO 27001 Certification [15]	Q3–Q4 2026 (M8–9)	$59K
SWIFT MT103 Bridge v1 [14] (testnet)	Q4 2026 (M9)	within dev budget
Preprint arXiv / IACR ePrint (public verification)	Q4 2026 (M9)	—
2+ banks: NDA + PoC Agreement	Q4 2026–Q1 2027	$18K
EMI license: obtained or in final review [11]	Q1 2027 (M12)	—
Outcome: full regulatory readiness, Phase 1 begins	Q1 2027	**$1.19M**

Table 41: Milestones: Phase 1 (Q1 2027–Q1 2028, funded from operating revenue)

Milestone	Quarter	Funding
EMI license confirmed [11]	Q1 2027	—
First paid pilot: 1 bank, 1 corridor (1.65–2.9%)	Q1–Q2 2027	Revenue
MiCA/CASP license obtained [8, 12]	Q2 2027	—
Break-even (10M tx/year)	Q2–Q3 2027	EBITDA ≥ 0
Groth16 compliance proofs [36] (production)	Q2 2027	From CF
Second bank: paid pilot	Q3–Q4 2027	From CF
Hire Head of BD from revenue	Q3 2027	From CF
ARR target at end of Phase 1 (Q1 2028)	Q1 2028	**$10–30M**

Table 42: Milestones: Phase 2 (Q1 2028–Q1 2029, revenue-funded)

Milestone	Quarter	Target
In-house ML AML ($0.0083 → $0.002–0.004/tx) [42]	Q1 2028	−50–75% compliance cost
ATM KYC Module (k-anonymity)	Q2 2028	1 ATM network
Proof Marketplace beta [40]	Q2 2028	5–10 external provers
3–5 bank partners (total)	Q3 2028	Pilot → Regional
Dynamic Sharding (DynShard) [38]	Q4 2028	1,000+ TPS
Series A ($8–15M) — optional	Q2–Q3 2028	Growth only
ARR target at end of Phase 2 (Q1 2029)	Q1 2029	**$30–100M**

Phase 2 (Q1 2028–Q1 2029): Scaling

Final Investment Thesis

$1.19M Pre-Seed	funds the only barrier — regulatory licensing [11, 8]
Profitability	achieved at 10M tx/year, equivalent to one bank partner
59.8% net margin	at 50M tx — higher than Visa [19] at national scale
6–30× exit	over 3–5 years via M&A [24, 25, 30, 32]
Series A optional	for acceleration only — not for survival

APPENDIX A: DATA ROOM CONTENTS

The following materials are available for due diligence upon execution of NDA:

APPENDIX B: THEORETICAL SCALE CEILINGS

The following projections represent mathematical extrapolations of the Economic Model v3.1 at National and Global scale. **These are not forecasts.** They illustrate the theoretical ceiling of the model's economics if volume

Table 43: Data Room Checklist

#	Document	Status
1	Technical Specification v4.0 (30+ formal theorems)	Available
2	Economic Model v3.1 (Excel/Google Sheets)	Available
3	Cap Table (detailed, post-Pre-Seed)	*Available upon NDA execution*
4	Founder CVs and LinkedIn profiles	*Available upon NDA execution*
5	PCT Patent Application (ZK+SWIFT Bridge)	*In preparation (target filing: Q2 2026)*
6	Sample Bank Pitch Deck (1-pager + full deck)	Available
7	Compliance Architecture Diagram	Available
8	SAFE Term Sheet (draft)	*Available upon investor interest confirmation*
9	UAB Registration Documents	*Post-close*
10	Auditor engagement letters (CertiK, ISO 27001 body)	*Post-close*

reaches these levels over a 5–10+ year horizon. The primary focus of this business plan is the path from $0 to $30M ARR (Pilot to early Regional).

Table 44: Theoretical Scale Ceilings (not forecasts)

Parameter	Pilot	Regional	National*	Global*
Volume (tx/year)	50M	1B	6B	40B
Fixed costs/year	$8.54M	$26.1M	$66.0M	$169.0M
Revenue (1.65%)	$45.4M	$907.5M	$5,445M	$36,300M
Net Profit	$27.2M	$651.7M	$3,978M	$26,722M
Net Margin	59.8%	71.8%	73.1%	73.6%

*Source: Economic Model v3.1. *National and Global are mathematical extrapolations, not operational forecasts.*

For additional materials
(Technical Specification v4.0, Economic Model v3.1, Due Diligence package)

please contact the Vipeink team directly.

vipeink.official@gmail.com

Confidential. March 2026.

References

[1] Bank for International Settlements (BIS) / CPMI. *Cross-border payments: a G20 priority* (Phase 1–4 Report Series). BIS, 2020–2023.

[2] McKinsey & Company. *The 2023 McKinsey Global Payments Report*. McKinsey, 2023.

[3] McKinsey & Company. *The 2024 McKinsey Global Payments Report*. McKinsey, 2024.

[4] European Central Bank. *Payments and Market Infrastructure in Europe*. ECB, 2023.

[5] Capgemini. *World Payments Report 2023*. Capgemini, 2023.

[6] MarketsandMarkets. *Blockchain in B2B Payments Market — Global Forecast to 2028*. MarketsandMarkets, 2023.

[7] Grand View Research. *Zero Knowledge Proof Market Size, Share & Trends Analysis Report*. Grand View Research, 2023.

[8] European Parliament and Council. *Regulation (EU) 2023/1114 on Markets in Crypto-Assets (MiCA)*. OJ EU, 2023.

[9] European Parliament and Council. *Regulation (EU) 2022/2554 — Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)*. OJ EU, 2022.

[10] European Parliament and Council. *Directive (EU) 2018/1673 (AMLD6)*. OJ EU, 2018.

[11] Lietuvos Bankas (Bank of Lithuania). *Electronic Money Institution License Requirements*. Bank of Lithuania, 2023.

[12] European Securities and Markets Authority (ESMA). *Guidelines under MiCA / CASP Licensing Requirements*. ESMA, 2023–2024.

[13] SWIFT and ISO. *ISO 20022 Migration Guide for Financial Institutions*. SWIFT, 2023.

[14] SWIFT Standards. *MT103 — Single Customer Credit Transfer: Standards Release Guide*. SWIFT, 2023.

[15] International Organization for Standardization. *ISO/IEC 27001:2022 — Information Security*. ISO, 2022.

[16] European Central Bank. *TIBER-EU Framework*. ECB, 2022.

[17] McKinsey & Company. *The Future of Financial Crime Compliance*. McKinsey, 2022.

[18] Financial Action Task Force (FATF). *FATF Recommendations on AML/CTF*. FATF, 2023.

[19] Visa Inc. *Annual Report 2023 (Form 10-K)*. Visa, 2023.

[20] Mastercard Inc. *Annual Report 2023 (Form 10-K)*. Mastercard, 2023.

[21] PayPal Holdings. *Annual Report 2023 (Form 10-K)*. PayPal, 2023.

[22] Stripe, Inc. *Stripe Payments Pricing Documentation*. Stripe, 2024.

[23] Stripe, Inc. *Financial Statements (Series I Filing Materials)*. Via Bloomberg/Reuters, 2023.

[24] Worldline SA. *Annual Report 2023*. Worldline, 2023.

[25] Adyen N.V. *Annual Report 2023*. Adyen, 2023.

[26] Temenos AG. *Annual Report 2023*. Temenos, 2023.

[27] Finastra Group Holdings. *Annual Report 2022*. Via rating agencies, 2022.

[28] FIS (Fidelity National Information Services). *Annual Report 2023*. FIS, 2023.

[29] Nuvei Corporation. *Annual Report 2023*. Nuvei, 2023.

[30] BNP Paribas S.A. *Annual Report 2023*. BNP Paribas, 2023.

[31] PitchBook / CB Insights. *Fintech M&A Multiples 2023–2024*. PitchBook, 2023–2024.

[32] ING Groep N.V. *Annual Report 2023*. ING, 2023.

[33] Dealroom.co / Sifted. *European Fintech Investment Landscape 2024*. Dealroom, 2024.

[34] Various analysts (Reuters, Bloomberg). *Stripe Financial Information*. 2023.

[35] Polygon Zero Team. *Plonky2: Fast Recursive Arguments with PLONK and FRI*. Polygon, 2022.

[36] Groth, J. *On the Size of Pairing-Based Non-interactive Arguments*. EUROCRYPT 2016. Springer, 2016.

[37] TON Foundation. *The Open Network: Technical White Paper*. TON, 2023.

[38] TON Foundation. *TON Blockchain Documentation*. TON, 2024.

[39] SWIFT. *SWIFT gpi: Enabling the Future of Cross-Border Payments*. SWIFT, 2023.

[40] Ethereum Foundation. *ZK-Rollups: Survey on Scalability and Security*. 2022.

[41] World Intellectual Property Organization. *PCT Database*. WIPO, 2024.

[42] FATF / Egmont Group. *Opportunities and Challenges of New Technologies for AML/CFT*. FATF, 2023.

[43] SWIFT. *SWIFT History and Milestones*. SWIFT, 2023.

[44] SWIFT. *Correspondent Banking Data Report 2023*. SWIFT, 2023.

[45] BIS / CPMI. *Correspondent Banking (CPMI Report No. 190)*. BIS, 2020.

[46] LexisNexis Risk Solutions. *True Cost of Financial Crime Compliance Study 2023*. LexisNexis, 2023.

[47] Wise plc. *Annual Report 2023*. Wise, 2023.

[48] Partior Pte. Ltd. *Partior: Blockchain for Interbank Clearing and Settlement*. Company website and press releases, 2023–2024. https://www.partior.com.

[49] Fnality International. *Fnality: Tokenised Forms of Central Bank Money*. Company disclosures, 2023–2024. https://www.fnality.org.

[50] R3 LLC. *Corda: The Enterprise DLT Platform*. R3, 2023. https://www.r3.com/products/corda/.

[51] Digital Asset Holdings / Canton Network. *Canton Network: Privacy-Enabled Interoperability*. 2023–2024. https://www.canton.network.

[52] Circle Internet Financial. *USDC and Circle Payments Infrastructure*. Circle, 2024. https://www.circle.com.